

A LESSON WITH CHARLIE PARKER

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #113

Taking lessons with your heroes is cheap and easy. Especially when they are dead. They don't charge for the lesson, and (for better or worse), you can hear most of their recorded history for free online. You just need to spend the time figuring out what the lesson is that they are asking you to learn. Charlie Parker definitely wants us to learn this particular line, this particular shape. He clearly valued it, since he played it six or eight times in every solo he ever played. If it's good enough for Bird, it's good enough for us. Take the lesson!

#1 - Chromatic approach to a minor 7th arpeggio



#2 - Chromatic approach to a dominant 7th arpeggio



#3 - Chromatic approach to a major 7th arpeggio



You'll notice that many of the shapes and notes begin to repeat themselves, even between very different chords. Notice #1 (measure 1) and #2 (measure 3), or #1 (measure 4) and #3 (measure 1). Once we have this shape under our fingers (and in our ears) in just a handful of keys, things begin moving quickly.